

WATSON, MARY JANE

The Webslinger's wife and one true love

WATSON, MARY JANE

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Mary Jane Watson-Parker

OCCUPATION

Fashion model, "B" movie actress, former star of daytime TV drama.

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT 5 ft 8 in

WEIGHT 120 lbs

EYES Green

HAIR Red

FIRST APPEARANCE

Amazing Spider-Man #25, (June 1965)

POWERS

Mary Jane has no special powers, but she is a talented dancer, model and actress; retains her fun-loving and optimistic outlook despite the numerous dangers and trials of being married to Spider-Man.

Mary Jane was the daughter of Philip and Madeline Watson. Her mother was a drama student who dreamed of being an actress, while her father was an aspiring novelist. They met and fell in love at college, and married as soon as they graduated, with Philip taking a teaching job to support his family while he worked on his first novel.

The couple had two daughters, Gayle and Mary Jane, and Madeline put her acting career on hold to stay at home and care for the girls.

UNSETTLED YOUTH

Frustrated with his inability to complete his novel, Philip began switching jobs, hoping each new location would spark his creativity. As a result, Mary Jane was constantly changing schools and having to make new friends. To cope with this, she developed an extrovert personality and became a bit of a class clown. The marriage of Mary Jane's parents was never happy, and they eventually called it quits. But Madeline and the girls had a good relationship with Philip's elderly sister, Anna Watson, who lived next door to the Parker family, and kept in touch with her after the split.

FIRST MEETING

Gazing out of her Aunt Anna's window, Mary Jane first saw Peter Parker when she was 13 years old. She later discovered that he was secretly SPIDER-MAN when she spotted him sneaking out of his Aunt May's house. Aunt Anna kept trying to get them together, but the outgoing Mary Jane didn't want anything to do with the bookish, sensitive boy who hid behind a mask. When they eventually met, however, she discovered that she was attracted to Peter after all. Feigning indifference, she flirted with his rival Flash THOMPSON and dated Harry Osborn (see GREEN GOBLIN), his best friend and roommate.

SPIDEY'S BRIDE

Mary Jane and Peter dated for years and eventually married. Mary Jane tried to get used to Peter's double life, but being married to Spider-Man put a lot of strain on the marriage. The couple separated for a while after Peter rescued Mary Jane from a stalker, who had taken her hostage and faked her death. Eventually, they reconciled.

When Spider-Man joined the Avengers, Peter moved Mary Jane and his Aunt May into Stark Tower. They lived there until Peter joined Captain America's resistance during the CIVIL WAR (see pp. 84-5), at which point they went underground. To save Aunt May's life after she was shot by a sniper targeting Peter, the couple traded their marriage to MEPHISTO, who erased it and all the happiness it had brought. **TD, MF**



After always missing each other, Peter finally met Mary Jane.



After repeatedly refusing to marry Peter, Mary Jane finally accepted his proposal. They were married at City Hall.

To save Aunt May's life, Mary Jane and Spider-Man made a deal with Mephisto which wiped their wedding from existence.



ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *Amazing Spider-Man* #42

After months of missing each other, Peter Parker finally meets Mary Jane Watson for the first time.

• *Amazing Spider-Man: Parallel*

Lives, tpb The early lives of Mary Jane and Peter are shown to have a lot in common.

• *Amazing Spider-Man Annual* #21

Mary Jane finally marries Peter Parker!